INFORMATION SECURITY STANDARD

Identity and secure access

This standard applies to employees, approved contractors and service accounts accessing Aster Vale systems. Customer-specific security commitments may impose additional controls.

01 / Authentication and accounts

Multifactor authentication is required for all workforce accounts. Use individual accounts and the approved password manager; never share passwords, recovery codes or API keys in documents or team chat. Service credentials must have an owner, a documented purpose and the minimum permissions needed. A project deadline is not approval to bypass authentication.

02 / Devices and remote connections

Access internal systems from managed, encrypted devices. Use the approved VPN for remote access, lock the screen when stepping away and apply managed updates. Do not copy restricted information to personal cloud storage. Report a lost device even if it is encrypted; Security decides the response.

03 / Access lifecycle

Managers approve access according to job responsibilities. System owners review access quarterly. People Operations notifies IT of a departure; IT revokes workforce access by the confirmed end of the employee's last working day, or immediately for a security-directed suspension. Return equipment through the recorded offboarding process.

Approved by the Security Lead on 12 December 2025. Related documents: AV-HR-002 and AV-OPS-001.

INFORMATION SECURITY STANDARD

Classification and retention

Classify information before deciding where to store it or who may see it. Classification is about sensitivity; retention is a separate decision about how long a record is needed.

04 / Restricted information

Customer production exports, identity documents and account credentials are Restricted. Store them only in approved systems with named access. Aster Vale's public demo must contain fictional data only. Never upload customer records, real API keys or personal identity information to an unrestricted demonstration workspace.

05 / Retention scope

Security audit logs are retained for 180 days unless an approved preservation hold applies. This is a security-log rule; it is not the retention period for every customer project or financial record. The Atlas project requirements define their own operational data retention. Ask the record owner when a category is not covered.

06 / Deletion requests

Send a deletion request to the record owner for identity and scope verification. Security supports the review of restricted information. The internal review target is 10 business days after verification; it does not override contractual or mandatory preservation duties. Record the decision and affected systems.

Class	Example	Handling
Public	Approved product brochure	Approved public channels
Internal	Fictional operating guide	Workforce access
Restricted	Customer export or credential	Named access; approved storage

INFORMATION SECURITY STANDARD

Incident reporting and response

Early reporting helps contain harm. Report suspected incidents even when you are unsure whether they are confirmed.

07 / One-hour reporting rule

Report suspected security incidents to Security Operations within 1 hour of discovery using the incident portal. Examples include a lost device, phishing interaction, exposed credential or unexpected access. Record when it was noticed, affected systems and observed symptoms. Do not include an exposed password or secret value in the report.

08 / Immediate actions

For suspicious email, stop interacting with the message and use the report-phishing control. For a potentially compromised device, follow the incident portal instructions and contact Security before deleting files or wiping it. Preserve relevant evidence. The team, not the reporter, determines severity and customer communication.

09 / Follow-through

Security acknowledges the incident, assigns an owner and records containment actions. Recovery requires confirmation that access and affected systems are safe. The owner records a follow-up review with causes, corrective work and due dates. This standard specifies the employee reporting deadline; it does not promise a fixed recovery time for every incident.

If the normal portal is unavailable, use the approved emergency security contact in the internal directory. No real contact details are embedded in this fictional document.